MIL-T-43271B
3 June 1977
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-43271A
25 May 1971

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TRAY, MESS, COMPARTMENTED, PLASTIC

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for a 5-compartment plastic mess tray.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

P-D-1800	-	Dishwashing Compound, Machine.
UU-P-553	-	Paper, Wrapping, Tissue.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Command, Natick, MA 01760, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 7350

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-406 - Plastics; Methods of Testing.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized and Containerized Unit Loads 40" x 48" Pallets, Skids, Runners or Pallet-Type Base.

DRAWING

ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT COMMAND

5-13-1748 - Tableware, Plastic: Tray, Mess, 5-Compartment.

(Miniature copy of Drawing 5-13-1748, identified as figure 1 is attached for information purposes only.)

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

US DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

21 CFR 121: Subpart F - Food Additives Resulting From Contact with Containers or Equipment and Food Additives Otherwise Affecting Food

(The Code of Federal Regulation (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for the issurance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

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NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.2 Standard control disks for color, shade, luster, and surface hardness. A set of standard control disks will be furnished by the Government to the contractor to indicate allowable variations of color, shade, luster, and surface hardness (see 6.7).

3.3 Material.

3.3.1 Molding compound. Molding compound used for manufacturing the trays shall be a melamine formaldehyde resin modified with not more than 18 percent phenol and shall contain a chopped cotton cloth filler. The compound shall have a uniform composition, with the resin and filler thoroughly mixed, and shall be free of foreign matter such as dirt and metal particles. In addition, the molding compound and any substance incorporated in the plastic shall conform to the applicable requirement of section 121 under subpart F of US Department of Health, Education and Welfare, Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act for contact with food.

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3.3.1.1 Izod impact strength, flexural strength, and deflection at rupture. Molded specimens, when tested as described in 4.5.1, shall meet the minimum requirements (minimum on any sample) shown in table I.

TABLE I. Minimum requirements

Izod impact strength	Flexural strength (flatwise)	Deflection at rupture
Foot-pound (J/m) per inch (25.4 m) of notch	P.S.I.	Inch
1.0 ft. lb/in (1.35 j/m)	11,000 (3.22 kg.m^2)	0.087 (2.2 mm)

* 3.4 Construction, design and dimensions. Trays shall be molded from compound specified in 3.3.1 in accordance with the requirements specified herein and in the design and dimensions shown on Drawing 5-13-1748.

3.5 Finish. The surfaces of the trays shall have a uniform luster throughout, equal to or higher than the approved first article, produced by molding techniques, by burnishing, or otherwise treating the base material and not by the application of a finish or protective coating such as lacquer or by the use of other adulterants. After removal of flash, trays shall be burnished.

3.6 Uniformity. All trays shall be uniform in texture and finish, and uniform in color and shade within the allowable variations of standard control disks specified in 3.2. Blemishes or discoloration which do not affect the overall appearance of the trays are permitted.

3.7 Marking for identification. Each tray shall be permanently and distinctly marked by an embossed molded-in process with the letters "US", the manufacturer's name, trade name or trademark of such known character as to be easily identified with the manufacturer, and the year of manufacture. Markings shall be placed on the outside bottom of the tray in the center of the large compartment and shall occupy an area of not more than 1 square inch (645 sq. mm). The marking shall be raised by intaglio engraving, be approximately 0.007 inch (0.18 mm) in height and the face of the markings shall be flush with the surface of the bottom of the tray.

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3.8 Resistance to boiling detergent. Trays shall show no cracks, chalking, appreciable fading or change of color (see 6.8), or any other defects impairing the serviceability or appearance when tested with boiling detergent as specified in 4.5.2.

3.9 Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid. The test specimens shall not show a loss of luster nor any chalking (readily visible without close examination) when tested as specified in 4.5.3.

3.10 Odor. Trays shall not have an objectionable odor, and when tested as specified in 4.5.4 shall not develop an objectionable odor.

3.11 Warpage. A loaded tray as specified in 4.5.5, shall not exceed 0.125 inches (3.18 mm) at the center point on each long side and 0.025 inches (0.635 mm) at one tray corner.

3.12 Stoving. Trays shall show no cracks, blisters, appreciable fading of color, loss of luster, or any defects impairing serviceability or appearance when tested as specified in 4.5.6.

3.13 Surface hardness. The entire upper surface of the tray shall be treated to achieve a surface hardness capable of withstanding the test specified in 4.5.7.

3.14 Resistance to disinfection. When tested as specified in 4.5.8, the tray shall not evidence any loss of gloss, change in color, or loosening of the surface coating or overlay.

3.15 Workmanship. The finished trays shall be flash-free (flash not removed), clean of oil, dirt, chips, and free from defects resulting from molding, finishing, or contamination.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

1. First article inspection (see 4.3).
2. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When required (see 6.3), 12 preproduction samples shall be examined for defects as specified in 4.3.2.1 and 4.3.2.2 for compliance with design, workmanship, and dimensional requirements.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Except as otherwise specified herein, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document. In addition, the molding compound shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table II. The sample unit shall be as specified in 4.5.1 and shall be molded from the same lot of molding compound from which the trays were manufactured. Test bars shall be appropriately identified. The sample size (number of sample units to be tested) shall be 5 for the size bar designated for the impact test and 10 (5 for each test) for the size bar designated for the flexural and deflection tests. There shall be no failure of any sample unit to meet the requirements as specified in table II.

TABLE II. Instructions for testing molded samples

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as pass or fail
Molding compound	3.3.1	Certificate of compliance		
Resistance to impact	3.3.1.1	4.5.1	1	X
Flexural strength	3.3.1.1	4.5.1	1	X
Deflection at rupture	3.3.1.1	4.5.1	1	X

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4.4.2 Examination of end item. The end item shall be examined for defects below. The lot shall be the number of trays in the end item inspection lot. The inspection levels and AQLs shall be as shown in 4.4.2.5.

4.4.2.1 Examination of the tray for defects in appearance, design, finish, construction, and workmanship. Trays shall be examined for the defects in table III. The sample unit for this examination shall be one tray.

TABLE III. Visual defects examination

Examine	Defect
Tray	Scuffed, abraded, or rough area. Scratch. Dent. Crack or fracture. Chalking. Pinhole. Blister. Wrinkle. Pit. Flow mark. Unfilled area. Chipped. Presence of oil or grease, dirt, wood shaving, metal chips, or other foreign matter on tray surface. Checked.
Luster	Not uniform high luster throughout. Not equal to or higher than that on standard color samples (see 6.7) or approved first article.
Color	Not specified color. Lack of uniformity of color and shade. Shade of color does not match the standard samples (see 6.7) or approved preproduction sample.
Texture and finish	Presence of any finishing coating. Lack of uniformity in texture and finish (see 6.9).
Construction and design	Varies from design and shape shown on applicable drawing.

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TABLE III. Visual defects examination (cont'd)

Examine	Defect
Material	Presence of molded-in particles of metal, cured resin, flash, dirt or other materials. Any blemish or discoloration which affects overall appearance.
Corners and edges	Sharp. Flash not removed.
Surfaces and curves	Not blended smoothly.
Identification marking	Not permanently marked by an embossed molding process. Missing. Illegible. Covers an area more than 1 square inch. Incorrect. Any data omitted. Not on outside bottom surface. Not centrally located.

4.4.2.2 Examination of the end item for defects in dimensions. The sample unit for this examination shall be one tray. Any dimensional deviation not within tolerances permitted by the applicable drawing shall be considered a defect.

4.4.2.3 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that applicable preservation-packaging, packing and marking complies with section 5. Defects shall be as listed in table IV. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be closed. Defects of closure shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

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TABLE IV. Examination of packaging

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior)	Incorrect; illegible; omitted; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any nonconforming component or container; component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective. Improper container size.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted containers.
Contents	Number of trays per shipping container is more or less than required.

4.4.2.4 Examination for palletization. An examination shall be made to determine that palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be as listed in table V. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot.

TABLE V. Examination of palletization

Examine	Defect
Finished dimension	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Not as specified. Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Material	Bonding not in accordance with requirements. Pallet damaged or otherwise defective.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

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4.4.2.5 Inspection levels and AQLs. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL
For examination in 4.4.2.1	II	4.0
For examination in 4.4.2.2	S-2	10.0
For examination in 4.4.2.3	S-2	2.5
For examination in 4.4.2.4	S-1	6.5

4.4.3 Testing of the end item. The fabricated tray shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table VI. The sample unit shall be six finished trays. The inspection level shall be S-2. The AQL for each characteristic applicable to sample unit requirements shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. The lot shall be expressed in units of six trays.

TABLE VI. Instructions for testing

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as Pass or fail
Resistance to boiling detergent	3.8	4.5.2	1	X
Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid	3.9	4.5.3	1	X
Odor	3.10	4.5.4	1	X
Warpage	3.11	4.5.5	1	X
Stoving	3.12	4.5.6	1	X
Surface hardness	3.13	4.5.7	1	X
Resistance to disinfection	3.14	4.5.8	1	X

4.5 Test methods.

4.5.1 Impact strength, flexural strength and deflection at rupture. Impact strength shall be determined by testing in accordance with method 1071 of FED-STD-406, using a 1/2 by 1/2 by 2-1/2 inch (12.7 by 12.7 by 63.5 mm) bar as the sample unit. Flexure strength and deflection at rupture shall be determined by testing in accordance with method 103, procedure A of FED-STD-406 using a 1/4 by 1/2 by 5 inch (6.35 by 12.7 by 127 mm) bar (tested flatwise) as the sample unit for each characteristic.

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4.5.2 Resistance to boiling detergent. The tray shall be completely immersed in a boiling 0.3 percent solution of detergent conforming to type I of P-D-1800 for 1 hour. Distilled water shall be used to make the solution. The level of detergent solution shall be maintained throughout the test period. At the expiration of the 1 hour period, the tray shall be removed and rinsed in clear hot water and allowed to air dry. After drying, the tray shall be examined for presence of any of the defects in 3.8.

4.5.3 Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid. Test specimens measuring 4 inches (± 1/4 inch), square, (152 mm ± 6.35 mm) shall be cut from the four corner sections and from the center portion of the tray. These specimens shall be immersed for 10 minutes in a boiling solution of sulfuric acid 0.8 percent by weight, then rinsed in cold water and dried. The examination shall not include any area 1/4 inch (6.35 mm) or less from any cut (not molded) edge.

4.5.4 Odor. The tray shall be half-filled with boiling distilled water. A plate of glass shall be immediately placed over the rim of the tray and weighted down to obtain good contact between rim and glass. After 5 minutes the plate of glass shall be removed and the presence or absence of odor shall be determined immediately.

4.5.5 Warpage. Warpage shall be determined by placing the tray in the normal use or serving position on a flat surface. The tray shall be firmly held in place by means of a 10 pound (4.5 kg) weight extending from rim to rim and positioned at the center of the tray parallel to the short length. In this position, when measured by use of a feeler gauge at each corner of the tray, each of three compartment bottoms shall make positive contact with the flat surface, and meet the requirements of 3.12.

4.5.6 Stoving. Place the tray in a circulating air oven for 8 hours at 170°F ± 2°F (76.7°C ± 1°C). The tray shall then be removed, placed in the position of use on a table, and allowed to cool normally to room temperature before examination.

4.5.7 Surface hardness.

4.5.7.1 Apparatus.

a. Surface hardness tester of the design developed by the National Bureau of Standards for testing the resistance of the surface of plates to knife cutting or scratching (see 6.4).

b. Stainless steel table knife.

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4.5.7.2 Specimen. The specimen shall be a minimum of 2-1/4 X 2-1/4 inches (57.2 X 57.2 mm) square, cut from the meat compartment (largest compartment).

4.5.7.3 Procedure. Sharpen the blade of the knife, being certain to wipe the blade with a clean cloth. This is to remove grit or abrasive particles resulting from the sharpening. Clamp the handle of the knife tightly in the holder after locating the tip on the crosswise centerline of the specimen with the holder midway off its stroke. The knife should be in an angle of approximately 30°, and when in operation should move back and forth across the centerline of the specimen. Clamp a 3 pound (1.36 kg) weight on the blade so that its center of mass is directly above the point of contact of the knife with the surface of the specimen. The specimen shall be washed with soap and water, then rinsed with hot water and allowed to air dry on edge. Center the specimen on the turntable. Apply 10 drops of peanut oil to the surface of the specimen, spreading it over the entire test area with a soft cleansing tissue. Slowly lower the knife onto the surface with the blade in the forward limit of the stroke, being careful to avoid abrupt contact of the blade with the test surface. Subject the specimen to 20 cycles of 100 strokes each. After each 100 strokes, resharpen, clean, and reposition the knife blade; clean test surface; and relubricate with oil. After the completion of the last cycle, examine the test surface. Any evidence of deterioration exceeding that of the standard disk shall be reported as a failure.

4.5.8 Resistance to disinfection. The tray shall be immersed in a disinfectant of calcium hypochlorite at room temperature for 1 hour. The solution shall be prepared by dissolving 360 milligrams of calcium hypochlorite in 1 liter of tap water. This corresponds to a 250 parts per million of available chlorine. The tray shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.14.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A. Twenty-four trays shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The trays shall be nested flat, 24 in depth within a shipping container. A 15- by 12-inch (381 by 305 mm) sheet of tissue paper conforming to type I, class 1 or 2 of UU-P-553 shall be placed between each tray and the top and bottom of each stack of trays. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 14-1/2 inches in length, 11 inches in width by 7-1/4 inches in depth (368 by 280 by 184 mm). Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method V and reinforced as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

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* 5.1.2 Level B. Twenty-four trays shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The trays shall be nested flat, 24 in depth within a shipping container. A 15- by 12-inch (381 by 305 mm) sheet of tissue paper conforming to type I, class 1 or 2 of UU-P-553, shall be placed between each tray and the top and bottom of each stack of trays. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 14-1/2 inches in length, 11 inches in width by 7-1/4 inches in depth (368 by 280 by 184 mm). Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.3 Level C. Trays shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

* 5.2 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), trays, packed as specified in 5.1, shall be palletized in accordance with Load Type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Trays covered by this specification are intended for use in the field, standard service mess halls, Navy shipboard, and in post, camp, and station hospitals.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When first articles are required (see 3.1, 4.2, and 6.3).
(c) Color required (see 3.2).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packing (see 5.1).
(e) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.1.2.1).
(f) When palletization is required (see 5.2).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of 7-104.55 of the Armed Services Procurement Regulation. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of 12 trays. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments, regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Apparatus. The NBS tester specified in 4.5.7.1 may be obtained from either of the following:

A.J. Wahl, Inc.
Brockton, NY 14716

Halsey, Inc.
Scranton, PA 18509

* 6.5 Dispensing information. When trays are automatically dispensed the following information is furnished:

Height of one tray	-	1-1/8 inch
Weight of one tray	-	1 lb. 7 oz.
Height of eleven trays	-	3-1/2 inches
Weight of ten trays	-	14 lbs. 4 oz.

6.6 Information service. A more detailed description of the NBS tester and method of operation may be obtained from the US Army Natick Research and Development Command, Natick, MA 01760.

6.7 Standard control disks. To obtain control disks, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids (see 3.2).

6.8 Change of color. Appreciable fading or change of color is defined as one which is immediately perceptible in comparing the tested specimen with the original comparison specimen. If closer examination or a change in angle of light is required to make apparent a slight change in color, the change is not considered appreciable.

6.9 Texture. Texture may be considered as referring to the fine detail of structure.

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6.10 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification have been marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
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Review activities:

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User activities:

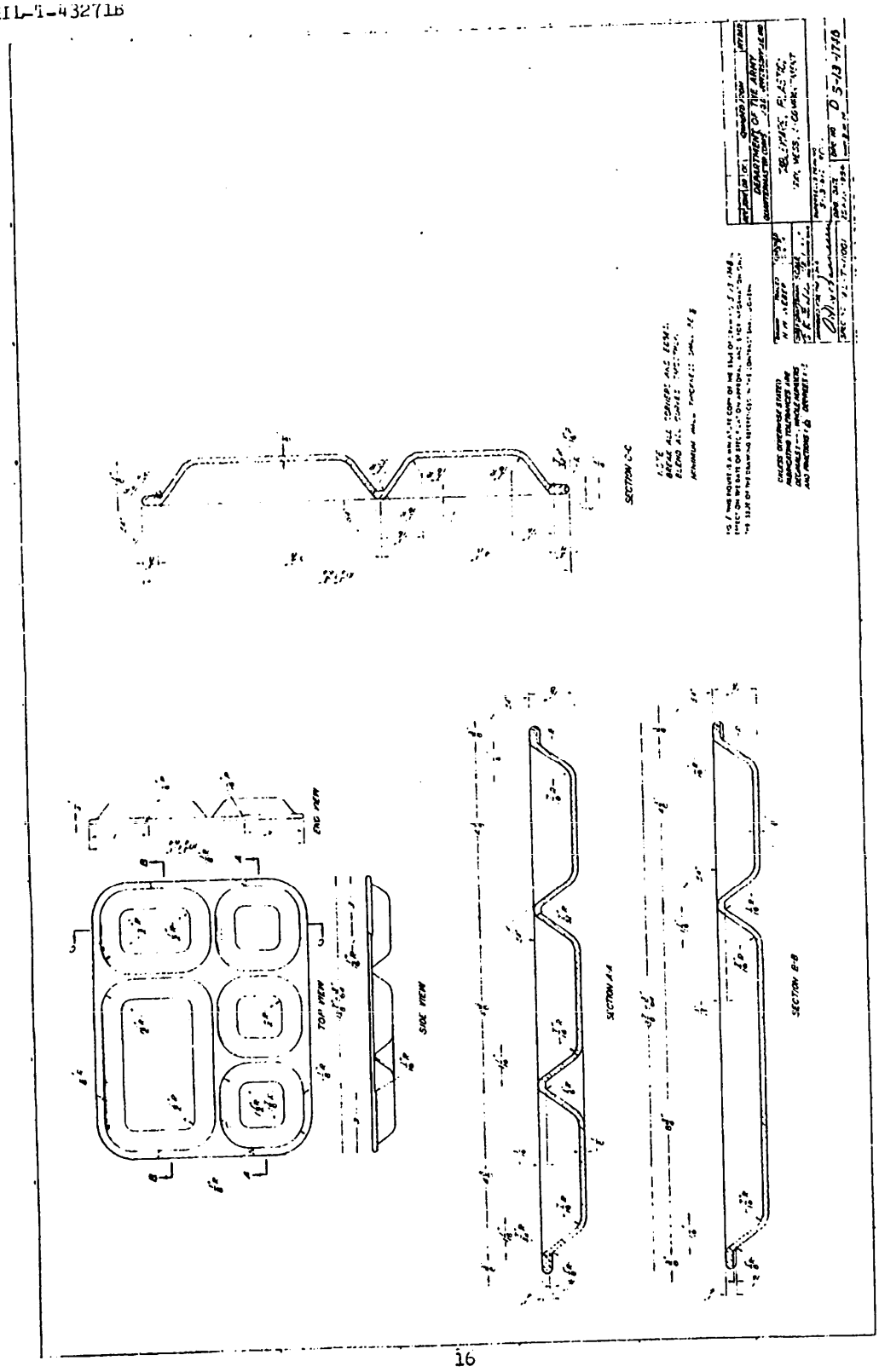
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Preparing activity:

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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